AfterAdmit MVP: User Workflow for Development

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Purpose and MVP scope

The MVP is a website that gives each admitted student a personalized checklist from accepting the offer to checking in on campus. The university provides it to its students, so each school gets its own branded version with its own deadlines and contacts. The students also see a community hub and a marketplace with multiple service providers, and AfterAdmit records each click to a provider as a lead.

In scope for the MVP

- Student sign-up through a university invite, with verification of the school email
- A short onboarding questionnaire that personalizes the roadmap
- A roadmap of 9 stages and about 45 milestones, each with tasks, guidance, and deadlines
- Progress tracking: the student marks milestones done, and progress is saved
- Vetted provider links on the relevant milestones, with click tracking for leads
- A feedback prompt on each milestone and a general feedback form
- Admin tools for the university and for AfterAdmit to manage content, deadlines, and providers
- Community hub (forums, peer chat)

Out of scope for the MVP

- In-app payments, booking, or applications with providers
- Uploading or verifying documents (I-20, visa, financial documents)
- Integration with university student information systems (SIS) or single sign-on (SSO)
- Premium concierge tier

User roles

The MVP has four roles. Each user belongs to one university, except AfterAdmit admins, who can see every university.

Role	Who	What they can do

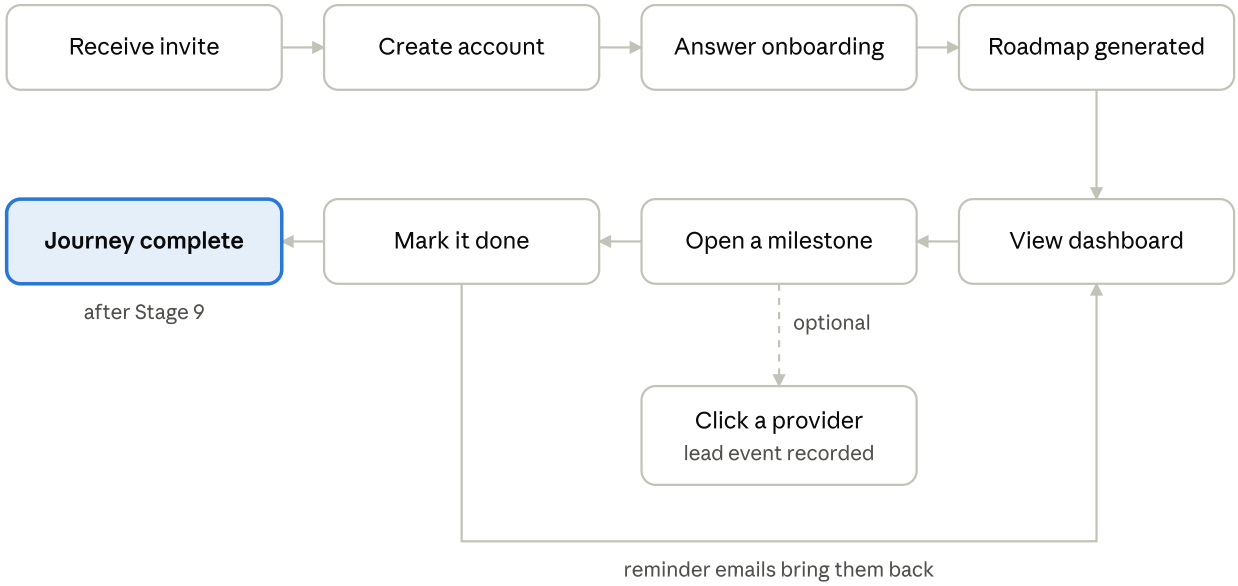
Student	Admitted students	Sign up by invite, complete onboarding, view their roadmap, mark milestones done, click provider links, give feedback, manage their profile and notification settings
University admin	Admissions staff	Upload or send student invites, set the school's deadlines and dates, edit school-specific guidance and contacts, turn milestones on or off, see aggregate progress for their students
Service Provider Partners	Service Providers such as loans, insurance, visa, housing, phone plan, moving and packing providers	
AfterAdmit admin	The AfterAdmit team	Create and edit universities, manage the master roadmap template, manage the provider directory, view leads and feedback across all schools

University admins see aggregate progress only, never which provider an individual student clicked. Student trust depends on this.

Student workflow

A student enters through a university invite, answers a short questionnaire, and then returns to one dashboard repeatedly over 4–6 months until they check in on campus. Each step lists what the student does and what the system does.

Students return to one dashboard until they check in on campus



Setup happens once; after that, the dashboard, milestone, and reminder loop repeats until Stage 9 is done.

1. **Receive the invite**
   - Student: gets an email from their university (sent through AfterAdmit) with a unique invite link.
   - System: creates a pending student record tied to the university and the intake term; the link expires after a set period.
2. **Create an account**
   - Student: sets a password or signs in with the same Google account they used to apply to school (or school email, not sure if by this time they will have one).
   - System: verifies the email against the invite (or the school's email domain), activates the account, and records consent to the terms and privacy policy.
3. **Complete onboarding (about 2 minutes)**
   - Student: answers 6–8 questions: program, home country, visa type (domestic, F-1 or J-1), funding source (scholarship, loan, sponsor, self), bringing dependents (yes/no), housing preference (on- or off-campus), and whether they have already accepted the offer.
   - System: stores the answers as profile attributes and generates the student's roadmap from the university's template (see Roadmap logic).
4. **See the roadmap for the first time**
   - Student: lands on the dashboard showing the 9 stages, overall progress, and the next 3 actions.

5. **Work through a milestone**
   - Student: opens a milestone and sees what it is, why it matters, the steps, the school contact, and any vetted providers.
   - System: shows only content that applies to this student (for example, dependent visa steps only if they have dependents).
6. **Use a provider (optional)**
   - Student: clicks a provider (for example, a loan lender or an insurance plan).
   - System: records a lead event (student, provider, milestone, timestamp) and opens the provider's site with a tracking parameter. The student leaves the app; nothing is purchased in the app.
7. **Mark a milestone done**
   - Student: ticks the milestone as complete, or ticks individual tasks inside it.
   - System: saves the status and date, updates stage and overall progress, and shows a one-question feedback prompt ("Was this helpful?" plus an optional comment).
8. **Update the profile**
   - Student: changes an answer (for example, financing type or housing choice).
   - System: keeping completed milestones and adding or hiding milestones as the new answers require.
9. **Arrive and finish**
   - Student: completes the Arrival stage (moved in, orientation done; international students have also entered the US and checked in with the international office).
   - System: marks the roadmap complete, sends a short end-of-journey survey, and keeps the account active through the first term.

Admin workflows

Admins set up the content before any student is invited. For the MVP, these screens can be simple forms and tables rather than a polished interface.

AfterAdmit admin: onboarding a new university

1. Create the university: name, logo, brand colour, email domain, office contact details.
2. Create an intake term (for example, Fall 2027) with the program start date and orientation date.
3. Copy the master roadmap template to the university.
4. Assign the school's providers: select which vetted providers appear, and on which milestones.
5. Invite one or more university admins.

AfterAdmit admin: ongoing

- Edit the master roadmap template (stages, milestones, tasks, guidance text, visibility rules)
- Add, edit, or deactivate providers in the directory
- View and export leads by provider, university, milestone, and date range (this drives billing for pay-per-lead)
- Review feedback across universities

University admin: setting up the school

1. Confirm or edit the term dates (start date, orientation, deposit deadline, housing deadline, insurance waiver deadline, health form deadline).
2. Review the roadmap: edit school-specific text, add links to school pages, turn milestones off if they do not apply.
3. Add contacts per stage (for example, the international student advisor for Stage 3).

University admin: inviting and monitoring students

1. Upload a CSV of admitted students (name, email, program, term) or add them one at a time.
2. Send invites, and resend to students who have not signed up.
3. View a dashboard of aggregate progress: sign-up rate, percentage complete per stage, and the share of students behind on key deadlines.
4. Export the aggregate report.

Roadmap logic

The roadmap is a template of stages and milestones that is filtered by the student's onboarding answers and dated from the university's term dates. Stages overlap in time; a student usually works on three or four at once.

Structure: Stage → Milestone → Task. A milestone is complete when the student marks it done (tasks are an optional finer checklist).

#	Stage	Milestones
1	Get Started	Offer accepted; deposit paid; school accounts active; join Slack/WhatsApp and community groups on AfterAdmit Transcripts and degree submitted;

2	Finance	Cost of attendance Check; Confirm funding sources ; loan secured (if needed) option to get support letter from partner service providers; financial documents submitted for the I-20 (*international only)*;
3	Visa *(international only)*	I-20 received; DS-160 submitted and interview booked; SEVIS fee paid; Document Checklist for visa
4	Academics	pre-program coursework done;
5	Healthcare	School insurance plan or waiver approved; immunization records uploaded; checkups done at home; prescriptions stocked
6	Housing	Housing type decided; roommates confirmed (check here); lease signed;
7	Essentials	US bank account planned or opened; international debit card ready (international only); home bank access set up (international only); packing list
8	Travel	Book Flight ticket link to service providers in marketplace with student discount codes, packing done and link to packing list; document kit assembled; arrival plan made;
9	Arrival	I-94 downloaded and international office check-in done (international only); orientation done; bank, SSN and essentials set up; moved in US phone plan active; wifi setup

Personalization (visibility rules). Each milestone and task can carry a simple rule based on onboarding answers. Examples:

- Show "Loan secured" only if funding source includes a loan.
- Show dependent visa tasks only if the student has dependents.
- Show DS-2019 wording instead of I-20 if the visa type is J-1.
- Show off-campus lease milestones only if the housing preference is off-campus.

A rule is a list of conditions (attribute, operator, value) joined by AND. Milestones with no rule are shown to everyone.

The most important rule is student type. The university sends AfterAdmit to every admitted student, domestic and international, so milestones marked *international only* (the Visa stage, I-20 financial documents, international card, home bank access, I-94 and

international office check-in) are hidden for domestic students. Everything else is shown to both.

Status. Each student milestone is in one of four states: not started, in progress, done, or not applicable (the student can mark a shown milestone as not applicable). Overdue is calculated, not stored: a milestone is overdue when it is not done and its due date has passed.

Dependencies. For the MVP, the app displays dependencies as guidance (for example, "Requires: I-20 received") but does not block the student from marking milestones done out of order.

Core data model

The model separates the master template (owned by AfterAdmit), each university's copy of it, and each student's progress. Field lists are a starting point for the developer to refine.

Entity	Key fields	Relationships and notes
University	id, name, logo, brand colour, email domain, international office contact	Has many terms, admins, students, and a roadmap
Term	id, university id, name (e.g. Fall 2027), program start date, orientation date, deposit deadline, housing deadline, insurance waiver deadline, health form deadline	Anchor dates for due-date calculation
User	id, email, name, role (student, university admin, AfterAdmit admin), university id, auth method, status	One role per user
Student profile	user id, term id, program, home country, visa type, funding sources, has dependents, housing preference, notification settings	Onboarding answers; drives visibility rules
Invite	id, university id, term id, email, token, status (sent, accepted, expired), sent at	Created by CSV upload or manually

Stage	id, roadmap id, number, name, description	9 per roadmap
Milestone	id, stage id, title, description, why it matters, anchor date field, offset days, visibility rule, school contact, order, active	Master template plus a university copy (store a link to the master milestone so template updates can be pushed)
Task	id, milestone id, text, order, visibility rule	Optional checklist inside a milestone
Student milestone	student id, milestone id, status, completed at, marked not applicable	One row per student per visible milestone
Provider	id, name, category (loan, insurance, housing, banking, remittance, phone, travel), description, logo, URL, tracking parameter, active	Vetted directory owned by AfterAdmit
Milestone provider	milestone id, provider id, university id, order	Which providers appear where, per university
Lead event	id, student id, provider id, milestone id, university id, clicked at	Basis for pay-per-lead billing; never shown to university admins at individual level
Feedback	id, student id, milestone id (optional), helpful (yes/no), comment, created at	Milestone prompt and general form
Notification log	id, student id, type, milestone ids, sent at, opened at	Prevents duplicate reminders

Notifications, integrations, security and privacy

The MVP needs email, authentication, and analytics; everything else is deliberately avoided.

Emails the system sends

Email	Trigger	Recipient
Invite	University admin sends or resends	Student
Welcome	Account activated	Student

Admin invite	AfterAdmit admin invites a university admin	University admin

All emails must be sent from AfterAdmit with the university's name and logo, and each must have an unsubscribe or notification-settings link.

Integrations

- Email delivery service (for example, SendGrid, Postmark, or Amazon SES)
- Authentication with email and password plus Google sign-in (for example, Auth0, Clerk, Supabase Auth, or Firebase Auth)
- Product analytics for page views and key events (sign-up, onboarding complete, milestone done, provider click)
- Provider links use outbound URLs with tracking parameters; no provider APIs in the MVP

Security and privacy

- Many students are international, so plan for GDPR (EU students) and similar laws, as well as US FERPA expectations because universities share student records.
- Collect only what personalization needs. Do not store passport numbers, visa numbers, SEVIS IDs, or financial document contents.
- Separate data by university: a university admin can only ever see their own school's students, and only aggregate progress.
- Never share student contact details with providers. A lead is a click to the provider's site; the student chooses what to share there.
- Encrypt data in transit (HTTPS) and at rest; use role-based access checks on every API endpoint.
- Let students download and delete their data.

Build sequence and open decisions

Build the student experience first using seeded data for one university, then add the admin tools that let schools run it themselves.

1. **Foundations:** data model, authentication, roles, and per-university data separation.
2. **Roadmap engine:** master template seeded with the 9 stages and milestones, visibility rules, and due-date calculation from term dates.
3. **Student app:** invite sign-up, onboarding, dashboard, milestone detail, marking done, profile editing.
4. **Providers and leads:** provider directory, placement on milestones, click tracking.
5. **Notifications:** daily job, digest, reminders, overdue nudges, notification settings.

6. **AfterAdmit admin:** university and term setup, template editing, provider management, lead and feedback export.
7. **University admin:** date and content editing, CSV invite upload, aggregate progress dashboard.
8. **Pilot:** launch with one university and one intake cohort; review feedback and lead data before adding schools.

Open decisions

- [ ] How students access the app: invite only, school email domain, or both
- [ ] Whether university admins can write their own milestones or only edit and hide AfterAdmit's
- [ ] How a university's preferred vendors (for example, its tuition payment partner) sit alongside AfterAdmit's vetted providers
- [ ] Whether a lead is counted on click or only on a confirmed conversion reported by the provider
- [ ] Tech stack and hosting, to be proposed by the developer
- [ ] Pilot university and intake term